

Home activity pack, ages 3 to 7

The Desert Buzz

Twelve pages to color, cut, trace, make and talk about, all from the story.
The value in this book: managing anger.

For use in your own home. Please don't share the file or post it online.

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For grown-ups

Read the story first, then pick one page a day. Each page takes 10 to 20 minutes. There are no wrong answers.

The big idea

It's okay to feel angry. When anger gets big, stop, take a deep breath and listen to your heart before you act.

The big line

"When anger buzzes loud, pause and listen to your heart."

Five words from the story

Word	What it means	Do it
angry	a hot, big feeling when something seems unfair	make fists and scrunch your face
accident	something that happens by mistake, not on purpose	shrug with open hands
stomp	to walk hard and loud with your feet	stomp twice
breath	the air you take in and let out	breathe in slowly, then out
calm	quiet and still inside	press your hands down gently

A gentle note

Feeling angry is okay. The message is about what we do with the feeling, never that anger is bad.

This guide is not therapy. If a child has frequent or very intense outbursts, talk with their family and your school team.

What you need

Crayons, a pencil, scissors, glue or tape, a few craft sticks or straws, and the book (or read it free on screen at doubleadventure.ca).

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Meet the friends

Cut out each card along the dashed line. Tape a craft stick on the back and you have a puppet. Act out the story!



Etoo

Pinacate beetle

A tiny beetle learning to calm his big anger



Bella

Honey bee

Etoo's best friend, who buzzes from flower to flower



The wise old scorpion

Giant desert hairy scorpion

Gives Etoo good advice

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How did they feel?

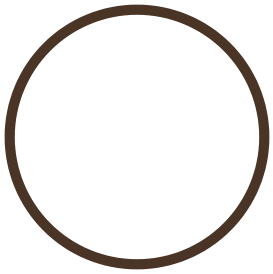
Feelings change during a story. Talk about each moment, then draw how the character felt.

Moment 1

Etoo and Bella explore the desert together.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

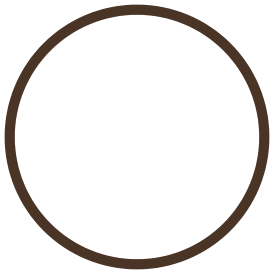


Moment 2

Bella flies off, her wings drooping.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

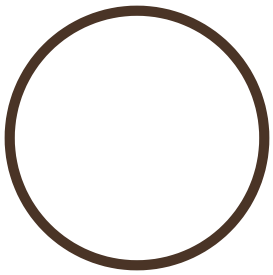


Moment 3

Both friends say sorry.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm



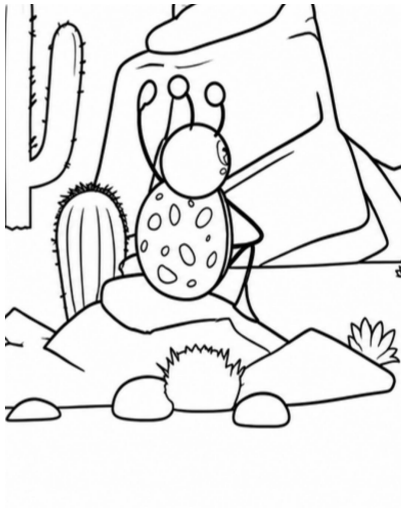
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Story in order

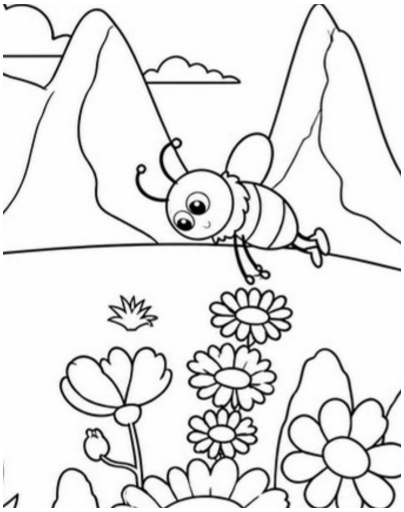
Color the pictures. Write 1, 2 and 3 in the boxes to show what happened first, next and last. Then cut them out and tell the story.



Color me ☐



Color me ☐



Color me ☐

Tell it in your own words

First, _____

Then, _____

At the end, _____

For grown-ups: the pictures come from the start, the middle and the end of the book. Younger children can just point and tell.

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Trace the words

Trace each word with a pencil. Then try writing it on your own in the empty space.

angry a hot, big feeling when something seems unfair

angry angry

accident something that happens by mistake, not on purpose

accident accident

stomp to walk hard and loud with your feet

stomp stomp

Etoo the hero of the story

Etoo Etoo

Write your name

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Draw your own story

Etoo showed managing anger. Draw a time when you showed managing anger too, or a time you could.



Tell a grown-up: What happened? How did you feel? How did the other person feel?

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Make and do

Pick one to try today. Each one comes straight from the story.

The tower falls

You need: Sand tray or blocks

Build a tower. A grown-up gently knocks it down ‘by accident’. Children practise: stop, breathe, say how they feel (‘I feel angry because…’), then rebuild it together.

Desert breeze breath

When you feel angry, breathe in slowly, then blow out like a soft desert breeze. Try it three times.

Waggle dance

Hide a toy, then do a dance to show where it is. Can your family find it?

Sand tower

Build a tower with blocks or sand. If it falls, what can you say or do?

Draw what you made

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The real animals

The animals in The Desert Buzz are based on real ones. Here is something true about each of them.



Etoo

Pinacate beetle

Because of its headstand, people also call it the clown beetle or the stink beetle.



Bella

Honey bee

Honey bees can taste with their feet!



The wise old scorpion

Giant desert hairy scorpion

It's the largest scorpion in North America.

Story or real?

The book doesn't name Etoo's kind of beetle, so we picked the pinacate beetle, a small black desert beetle. When it gets upset it does a headstand and sprays, so it knows all about big feelings!

Where they really live

The book's desert has no name, but its tall cactuses look like saguaros, so we picked Saguaro National Park in Arizona. Pinacate beetles and desert hairy scorpions live in this desert.

Facts and sources: doubleadventure.ca/heroes/the-desert-buzz

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Color the story

Color this page from the book. What is happening here?



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Talk together cards

Cut out the cards and keep them in a jar. Pull one out at dinner, in the car or at bedtime.

Who are these two friends? Where do they live?

The Desert Buzz, talk card 1

Why did Etoo get so angry?

The Desert Buzz, talk card 2

Was it fair when Etoo said Bella always ruins everything?

The Desert Buzz, talk card 3

How do you think Bella felt when Etoo stomped away?

The Desert Buzz, talk card 4

What helped Etoo calm down?

The Desert Buzz, talk card 5

What helps you when you feel a big angry feeling?

The Desert Buzz, talk card 6

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Managing anger hero

This is to say that

_____

showed managing anger, just like Etoo.

_____ _____

Signed Date

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